To reply to an actor, you can use the more specific `thenReply`, which is provided as a convenience method. Add `.withEnforceReplies` to your persistent entity, and it will throw a compilation error if no `thenReply` is added.

Finally, you can add `thenStop` to stop the actor if needed. For example, you may want to stop the container if it has been emptied. To do so, use something like this:

```
case StopIt =>
     Effect.none.thenStop()
```

Buffering in Akka

In some cases, you may want to wait until your application has reached a certain state before processing messages: for example, not processing any message until some initial values have been loaded from the database. For this purpose, you can add the following after `thenRun`:

- `stash`—Keeps the commands in a buffer
- `unstash all`—Flushes the commands from the buffer, which can be done with `thenUnstashAll`

It is important to note that this buffer only lives in memory and is lost when the actor restarts or stops. This can happen with any exception, but with a persistent failure, it can be handled so that the buffer is not lost. You can handle this scenario by using `EventSourcedBehavior.onPersistFailure` with a `SupervisorStrategy .restartWithBackoff`, available in the Akka Persistence API.

Stashing and unstashing happen automatically when one or multiple events are persisted. Commands are buffered while persisting; when persistence succeeds, they are unstashed.

9.3 Customizing the persistent entity

Now that you know some of the problems you face when managing persistent actors, let's try to solve some of them.

9.3.1 Failure

If `persist` fails, you can recover by adding a `restartWithBackoff` supervision strategy, setting it via `.onPersistFailure`:

```
EventSourcedBehavior[Command, Event, State](
  persistenceId = ...,
  emptyState = ...,
  commandHandler = ...,
  eventHandler = ...,
).onPersistFailure(                          ❶
    SupervisorStrategy.restartWithBackoff(
       minBackoff = 10.seconds,
       maxBackoff = 60.seconds,
       randomFactor = 0.1))
```